

AROUND THE DECK



▲ AIRCRAFT WEAPONRY

Most of the *George Washington's* formidable firepower is reserved for its aircraft. The range of airborne weapons include bombs, rockets, guided missiles, and torpedoes.



▲ ELEVATOR

Four hydraulic lifts, one to port and three to starboard, move aircraft between the hangar and the flight deck. They also take containers of stores or spare parts to and from the hangars.



► HELICOPTER MAINTENANCE

An aircraft carrier's helicopters perform many roles, including anti-submarine work, rescue missions, and the transportation of personnel.



▲ ISLAND SUPERSTRUCTURE

Much of the electronics, including radar and satellite communications equipment, is based on the island, which has the ship's number painted on its sides.

▼ FLOATING AIRSTRIP

Carriers such as the *George Washington* provide the strategic benefit of a mobile strike platform that can operate from anywhere in international waters.

